

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3



♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ K

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5 N:S3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ K, West played the ♠ 7 and North the ♠ 5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦ 10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠ 6, ♠ 5, ♠ 4, ♠ 3 and ♠ 2. So the ♠ 7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠ A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦ 10 West will win the ♦ A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠ A while you still have the ♣ A for an entry.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2



♠ J 7 5

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

1 ♣

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠K

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving South ♠ A J 8 5. South played the ♠ 8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8 N:S3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, East played the ♠7 and South the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out South's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 3
 ♥ Q 10
 ♦ 10 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9
 ♥ A 9 7 5 2
 ♦ A K
 ♣ 10 9 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 4
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2
 ♥ K J 8 3
 ♦ Q 8 6
 ♣ J 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	2 ♣	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣ A			

[showcards W:CA N:C4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.
Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 4

Play the ♣ 8 to encourage a continuation. East will
play the ♣ Q on which you will play the ♣ 2.

East now knows you started with a doubleton, and
more importantly, he also knows you want him to
play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣ K dummy will ruff, but
whatever card he ruffs with you will have established
a trump trick. When you later win your ♠ K that will
be down 1.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
 ♥ J 8 4 3
 ♦ K J 9 5 2
 ♣ 8 2

♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5



♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 10 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

♠ A K 5

♥ A K Q 5

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 3

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦5			

[showcards S:CQ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, East wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. South holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that East holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If East is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it South's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ Q J 9
♦ K 9 5 2
♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

[showcards W:CA N:C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.